

Ravindu Nawanjana

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Colombo, Sri Lanka

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Environmental and resource economics; climate finance and the cost of capital in developing economies; blended finance and the architecture of multilateral climate funds; retail banking and deposit mobilisation for climate adaptation and disaster risk reduction; energy economics and clean technology adoption; natural capital, carbon markets and regenerative agriculture; institutional economics and climate policy in the Group of 77 and China; Small Island Developing States and Least Developed Countries.

EDUCATION

London Metropolitan University London, United Kingdom
Masters of Science in International Banking and Finance, GPA: 3.7 / 4.0 (WES Certified)
August 2026
Thesis: The Role of Multilateral Climate Funds in Shaping the Architecture of Climate Finance: An Analysis of Blended Finance and Institutional Collaboration among MDBs, Central Banks, and Private Capital across the G77 and China
Theoretical contribution: Institutional Reinforcement Cycle (IRC), a framework modelling the feedback dynamics between public multilateral institutions and private capital deployment in climate finance architecture.
Methods: Mixed-methods design combining a 103-respondent survey with eight semi-structured expert interviews with senior practitioners at UNDP, UNCDF, UN Sustainable Stock Exchanges, FAO, African Development Bank, Asian Development Bank, the World Bank GEF, a central bank and a private capital firm, analysed through reliability analysis, correlation, multiple regression with diagnostics and thematic content analysis.

London Metropolitan University London, United Kingdom
Bachelors of Science (Hons) in Banking and Finance
August 2025
Thesis: The Role of Stock Exchanges in Promoting the Banking Sector in Adopting Green Finance: A Global Analysis with Insights from Emerging Markets

PUBLICATIONS

1. Nawanjana, R. (2025). The Role of Stock Exchanges in Promoting the Banking Sector in Adopting Green Finance: A Global Analysis with Insights from Emerging Markets. Proceedings of the 16th International Conference on Sustainable Built Environment (ICSBE 2025), Paper ID: ICSBE25_005. ISSN 3051-5874. SSRN.
2. Nawanjana, R. (2026). The Role of Multilateral Climate Funds in Shaping the Architecture of Climate Finance: An Analysis of Blended Finance and Institutional Collaboration among MDBs, Central Banks, and Private Capital across the G77 and China. Proceedings of the 3rd International Conference on Biomimicry for Sustainability (ICBS2026), Paper ID: ICSB26_055. ISSN 3093-6020. SSRN.

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

1. Nawanjana, R. The Role of Stock Exchanges in Promoting the Banking Sector in Adopting Green Finance: A Global Analysis with Insights from Emerging Markets. Submitted to Climate and Development (Manuscript ID: 261197315). Under revision.
2. Nawanjana, R. Practitioner Perspectives on Institutional Collaboration and Multilateral Climate Funds in the Group of 77 and China. Submitted to Climate and Development (Manuscript ID: 267423613). Under revision.

ACADEMIC ENGAGEMENT

Yale School of the Environment September 2026 - Present
Participant, Yale Forest Forum Fall 2026 Speaker Series

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Economic Change and Restructuring (Springer Nature) April 2026 - Present
Ad-Hoc Reviewer

- Invited by editors to provide double-blind peer reviews for research manuscripts submitted to the SSCI-indexed journal (2025 Impact Factor: 3.8).
- Critically evaluated advanced econometric methodologies, empirical data structures, and theoretical alignment with global economic development frameworks to guide editorial decisions.
- Completed two review rounds on one manuscript, covering the original submission and its revision, with a third review in progress, in the areas of corporate environmental governance and urban sustainability.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations July 2025 - Present
Country Representative, World Food Forum - Sri Lanka Chapter
Headquartered in Rome, Italy

- Chair the World Food Forum Sri Lanka chapter with 500+ members across 14+ universities in 9 provinces, operating under the FAO.
- Represent the chapter before the Ministry of Agriculture and the Ministry of Environment, and coordinate with Mr. Nalin Munasinghe, Assistant FAO Representative (Programme), FAO Sri Lanka, to bring the voices of communities affected by food insecurity into national and international policy forums.
- Contributed to a case study in Sri Lanka on Bokashi fermented organic fertiliser as a non-petrochemical input for smallholder agriculture.
- Advance science-based approaches to a just transition in agriculture, including alternate wetting and drying (AWD), methane reduction strategies and non-petrochemical input adoption, consistent with Sri Lanka's NDC commitments.
- Develop grassroots research partnerships between student networks and FAO-aligned institutions to scale field-level evidence on sustainable agricultural outcomes.

The Commonwealth Secretariat July 2025 - Present
Country Representative, Sustainable Energy Transition Youth - Sri Lanka
London, United Kingdom

- Lead and represent Sri Lankan youth within the Commonwealth's sustainable energy agenda across 56 member states, chairing the country's director board and reporting to the Commonwealth Executive Committee.
- Oversee 3 district-level taskforces comprising government, private sector, NGO, and university stakeholders, with a total member board exceeding 300.
- Currently drafting Sri Lanka's youth-led national framework for energy transition, with proposed project initiations in green hydrogen and solar energy, and university partnerships to advance feasibility research for small modular nuclear energy.

Kangara Holdings Pvt Ltd September 2024 - Present
Head of Impact Investments and Sustainability - Colombo, Sri Lanka

- Lead the design of Sri Lanka's proposed first large-scale agriculture, forestry and other land use (AFOLU) carbon credit programme, spanning reforestation and agriculture across 100,000 to 200,000

hectares, with projected carbon credit revenue of $364M to $450M per annum at maturity, alongside waste-to-energy projects and electric vehicle charging centres.

- Designed and conducted, with the Government of Sri Lanka, the additionality assessment for the agricultural carbon credit programme, a difference-in-differences comparison of adopters and non-adopters of regenerative practice changes that tested each intervention against the Verra VM0042 5 percent quantitative change threshold and 20 percent common practice ceiling.
- Negotiated an agricultural carbon credit agreement with rice farmers in Sri Lanka's dry zone.
- Prepared Project Design Documents (PDDs) under Verra VM0047 for Afforestation, Reforestation and Revegetation (ARR) and VM0051 for Improved Management in Rice Production Systems, drafted a PDD under the CDM methodology ACM0022 (Alternative Waste Treatment Processes) for municipal waste-to-energy facilities, and applied VM0038 to structure carbon credits for the programme's electric vehicle charging component.
- Authored and submitted an Expression of Interest to the Climate Investment Funds (CIF) Industry Decarbonization Program (up to $250M per country in concessional finance) in collaboration with the Climate Change Secretariat, Ministry of Environment, Sri Lanka (2025), applying the Verra VM0042 methodology across 6,000 hectares and 8,000 farmers.
- Pursued $21M in grant funding from multilateral development banks, including the Climate Investment Funds (World Bank Group), preparing technical and financial documentation aligned with blended finance standards.
- Managed a cross-border impact investment portfolio (UAE, Maldives, Oman, Malaysia, Sri Lanka) with integrated ESG compliance across GRI, SASB, CDP, TCFD, and SBTi frameworks.

CIVIL SOCIETY

CuteFela - Wildlife Conservation Organisation August 2023 - Present
Founder and President of the Board - Colombo, Sri Lanka
Registered under Certificate No. WU18393.

- Founded a Sri Lankan wildlife conservation civil society organisation, accredited to the UNCCD, focused on mobilising private sector investment in conservation with measurable financial returns.
- Initiated 3+ projects to restore protected wildlife sanctuaries and animal shelters, collaborating with the Ministry of Wildlife Conservation and the Department of Zoological Gardens.
- Deliver educational workshops, with access to 19 national parks, 2 national zoos, an elephant orphanage and a safari park through partnerships with government stakeholders.

UN CONVENTION DELEGATIONS

UNCCD COP17 Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia, 2026

UNFCCC COP30 Belém, Brazil, 2025

UNCCD COP16 Riyadh, Saudi Arabia, 2024

UNFCCC COP29 Baku, Azerbaijan, 2024

UNFCCC COP28 Dubai, UAE, 2023

OTHER UN ENGAGEMENTS

World Green Economy Summit (WGES 2026) October 2026
2026 Fellow, WGEO Global Green Economy Young Leaders Programme, Dubai, UAE. Organised by WGEO, DEWA and the Dubai Supreme Council of Energy.

Summit of the Future, Asia-Pacific Regional Convening August 2024
Asia-Pacific Regional Convening Ahead of the Summit of the Future, Young People at the Forefront, Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia.

5th Asia-Pacific Environment Forum October 2023
Fifth Forum of Ministers and Environment Authorities of Asia Pacific, Colombo, Sri Lanka.

POLICY AND GRANT ENGAGEMENT

Climate Investment Funds (CIF), Industry Decarbonization Program 2025
Principal author, Expression of Interest, submitted through the Climate Change Secretariat, Ministry of Environment, Sri Lanka.

EUROPEAN UNION ENGAGEMENT

European Commission, DG Climate Action 2023 - Present
Engagement since COP28 with Samuele Fischetti, Policy Assistant in the Multilateral Affairs unit (D.1), which coordinates the EU delegation to the UNFCCC, and with Stella Brozek-Everaert on Loss and Damage.

CONFERENCE AND POLICY PRESENTATIONS

2026 World Green Economy Summit (WGES 2026), Dubai, UAE - Speaker, WGEO Youth Roundtable, representing CSET Youth Sri Lanka.

2026 International Conference on Business Innovation (ICOBI 2026), Colombo, Sri Lanka - Paper presentation.
Panel: Dr. Christopher Agyapong Siaw (University of Plymouth, United Kingdom), Dr. Danqing Liu (University of Plymouth, United Kingdom), Dr. Neelangi Nanayakkara (University of Sri Jayewardenepura, Sri Lanka) and Prof. Athula Manawaduge (University of Sri Jayewardenepura, Sri Lanka).

2026 3rd International Conference on Biomimicry for Sustainability (ICBS 2026) - Paper presentation.
Panel: Dr. Niranjika Wijesooriya (University of Sydney, Australia), Dr. Kinkini Hemachandra (University of Huddersfield, United Kingdom) and Dr. Asitha De Silva (University of Colombo, Sri Lanka).

2026 UNCCD COP17, Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia - Registered Business and Industry Entity.

2025 UNFCCC COP30, Belém, Brazil - CSO delegation, UNFCCC formal proceedings.

2025 International Conference on Sustainable Built Environment (ICSBE 2025) - Paper presentation.
Panel: Prof. Priyan Mendis (University of Melbourne, Australia), Prof. Upul Attanayake (Western Michigan University, USA), Dr. Rohitha Weerasinghe (University of Bedfordshire, United Kingdom) and Dr. Achela K. Fernando (Griffith University, Australia).

2024 UNCCD COP16, Riyadh, Saudi Arabia - Registered Business and Industry Entity.

2024 UNFCCC COP29, Baku, Azerbaijan - CSO delegation, UNFCCC formal proceedings.

2023 UNFCCC COP28, Dubai, UAE - National delegation, UNFCCC formal proceedings.

MEDIA COVERAGE

Earth Negotiations Bulletin (International Institute for Sustainable Development) October 2023
Coverage of my remarks on youth engagement in social entrepreneurship at the Science-Policy-Business Forum youth segment of the Asia Pacific Youth Environment Forum, held with the 5th Forum of Ministers and Environment Authorities of Asia Pacific, Colombo. enb.iisd.org/forum-ministers-environment-authorities-asia-pacific-5-2oct2023

Ministry of Environment, Sri Lanka December 2023
Video statement on biodiversity loss in the Asia-Pacific and the case for bringing natural capital into the economic models that drive markets and policy. youtu.be/hzbuuYGBDK0

SPECIALISED CERTIFICATIONS AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Climate Ambition Accelerator September 2025
United Nations Global Compact.

Advanced Diploma in Financial Markets August 2024
Colombo Stock Exchange. Credential ID: ADFM/23/B8/489.

IBM Quantum Learning, Qiskit In progress
Coursework in quantum computing and quantum information on the IBM Quantum Platform, using Qiskit on the IBM Quantum Heron and IBM Quantum Nighthawk r2 processors.

SKILLS

Applied quantitative methods: Difference-in-differences; multiple regression with diagnostics (Mahalanobis distance, Cook's distance, leverage); correlation analysis; reliability analysis (Cronbach's alpha); exploratory

factor analysis; bootstrapping; common method bias testing; survey design and sampling (103 respondents); DCF modelling.

Econometrics: Linear regression and inference; panel data and fixed effects; causal inference, including instrumental variables, difference-in-differences and regression discontinuity.

Mathematics: Single and multivariable calculus; linear algebra, including eigenvalues, eigenvectors and quadratic forms; real analysis; constrained optimisation with Lagrangian and Karush-Kuhn-Tucker methods; differential and difference equations; dynamic optimisation.

Probability and statistics: Random variables and distributions; expectation and variance; statistical inference; asymptotic theory.

Economic theory: Calculus-based intermediate microeconomics; mathematical microeconomics.

Carbon markets and ESG: Verra AFOLU methodologies VM0042, VM0047 and VM0051; VM0038 for electric vehicle charging; CDM methodology ACM0022 for alternative waste treatment; Project Design Document (PDD) preparation; additionality assessment; GRI, SASB, TCFD, CDP and SBTi frameworks.

Programming and software: R; Python; Stata; Qiskit (quantum computing); IBM SPSS Statistics; CSS; HTML; Quarto; JavaScript; C#; Microsoft Excel (advanced).

Qualitative methods: Semi-structured expert interview design; thematic content analysis; policy analysis; institutional mapping.

Fellowships and memberships: Fellow, World Green Economy Organization (WGEO) Global Green Economy Young Leaders (GGEYL) Programme 2026 (from October 2026); Member, IUCN Species Survival Commission Young Professionals Task Force (IUCN SSC YPTF) and IUCN SSC Asia; Registered Stakeholder Member, UNFCCC Glasgow Committee on Non-market Approaches (GCNMA); Member, C40 Youth; Member, World Economic Forum Global Shapers Community, Colombo Hub.

Interests: Teaching in rural schools across Sri Lanka, Basketball, Swimming, Hiking, Theatre, Piano.

Languages: English, Sinhala, French, Arabic.